constructive attitude, a standard phrase used to justify its opposition on any issue. Chen Jingye, Director General, Department of Arms Control, Chinese Ministry of Foreign Affairs, also preserved China's future position in NSG on matters relating to India, by saying that it hoped that the NSG would equally address the aspirations of all parties (they meant Pakistan) for the peaceful use of nuclear energy while adhering to the NPT mechanism. [28] China showed that it preferred to live to fight another day.

The Chinese Foreign Minister, Yang Jiechi, was scheduled to visit India on 9 September 2008. The ensuing decision in the NSG fundamentally changed the nature of his visit to India. There was serious consideration within the Government of India on whether or not to proceed with the visit, and also on whether or not to agree to a Chinese request for a meeting with Prime Minister Dr Manmohan Singh. Better sense appeared to prevail and the visit and the meeting with the Prime Minister went ahead. [29] In line with typical Chinese diplomatic behaviour and without so much as a reference to the happenings in Vienna scarcely forty-eight hours earlier and which was still very much the subject of media attention in India, Foreign Minister Yang Jiechi talked of the requirement by both India and China for clean energy, and said that the Chinese side was willing to remain in contact with the Indian side on cooperation in the peaceful uses of nuclear energy. [30] Four days later, the *Guangming Ribao*, a prominent Chinese daily, also publicly referred to the door being opened for Chinese companies to participate in the Indian nuclear energy market. [31] India and China resumed normal exchanges. The Indian NSA M.K. Narayanan travelled to China later in the same month. He became the first senior member of the Government of India to officially meet with the new Vice President of China, Xi Jinping (the author accompanied the NSA for this meeting). Xi Jinping